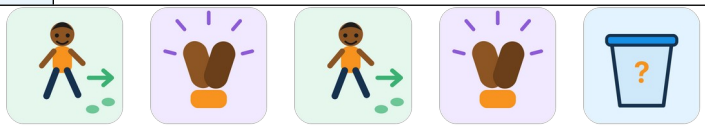
02 · Lesson spec

Finish What Comes Next · 40 minutes · whole class, then pairs · fully unplugged

Goal	**I can say what comes next.**
Core parts	Move + Code
Key words	next · predict · guess · check · missing
Materials	Gap pattern strips (Printables); large red and blue card counters (counted out per pair); one plastic cup per pair; move cards (walk, clap)



1. Watch (5 min)

- Be the teacher-robot: step, clap, step, clap… then freeze. Ask: “What will I do next?” Children predict: clap!
- **Say:** “When we guess what comes next, we **predict**. Now let’s **check**!” Do the clap.
- **Ask:** “How did you know?” (it repeats: step, clap)
- **Hand signs:** predict = tap your head then point forward · check = thumbs up · missing = open empty hands · next = point forward · guess = shrug and smile.

2. Do in pairs (25 min)

a) Guess and check, whole class (7 min) · Core: Move

- The teacher-robot does a pattern and freezes; children say their prediction, then the robot shows the next move.
- Mix it up: march, jump, march, jump… freeze! Clap, stamp, clap… freeze!

b) Find the missing card (8 min) · Core: Code

- Show a gap strip: red, blue, ?, blue, red, blue. **Say** “1–2, 1–2” while pointing. Children choose the missing card.
- Pairs try more gap strips from the Printables.

c) Prediction game with a cup, pairs (10 min)

- **Count counters out** to each pair. One child makes a counter pattern and **hides the next counter under a cup**.
- The partner predicts aloud, then lifts the cup to check. Swap. **Count counters back in.**
- **Stretch:** spot the mistake in a pattern (red, blue, red, red, red, blue).

3. Share (10 min)

Activity Book page (4 min): draw what comes next; circle the missing piece. Not marked.

- **Create:** draw a pattern and leave the last box empty for a friend to finish.
- **Close:** “Smart thinkers predict, then check. That is how coders test their ideas!”

Common mistakes

- Guessing without looking at the pattern → “Say it with me first: 1–2, 1–2… what comes next?”
- Lifting the cup before predicting → “Predict first, then check!”

What if it doesn’t work?

- No cups → cover the counter with a hand or a piece of paper.
- No counters → use the teacher-robot game with movements only.

Support and stretch

- **Support:** gap at the end only (what comes next), before gaps in the middle.
- **Stretch** (optional, never assessed): spot the mistake.

How we check

Observation only. Tick each child who **predicts the next item or move in a pattern**.

> **Safety**
> Large card counters only, no bottle caps. Count counters out and back in. Plastic cups only.